

# LOVE IN THE RUIN — UI Design Specification

## LOVE IN THE RUIN - UI Design Specification

A complete description of the **user interface only** - how it looks, behaves, and communicates the rhythm, emotion, and structure of the song.

This document excludes backend, metadata, and architecture. It focuses purely on **visual design, interaction, and motion language**.

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### 1. UI Philosophy

The UI is built on three principles:

- **Music drives everything** - visuals never move arbitrarily; every motion is tied to stems, beats, or words.
- **Sections have identities** - each part of the song feels like a different emotional environment.
- **Typography is expressive** - words behave like characters in the story.

The interface is not static; it breathes with the song.

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### 2. Core UI Layout

The screen is divided into three functional layers.

#### 2.1 Top Layer - Section Header

- Displays the current section label (Intro, Hook, Verse, Bridge, Outro)
- Animates in/out on section change
- Color and typography shift based on section type

#### 2.2 Middle Layer - Lyric Line Display

This is the emotional center of the UI.

##### Features:

- Large, horizontally aligned text
- One line visible at a time
- Next line fades in subtly beneath
- Active word glows or scales when triggered

##### Behaviors:

- Words highlight based on timestamps
- Accent words pulse on beat

- Typography weight changes based on speaker

## 2.3 Bottom Layer - Multi-Stem Waveform

A stacked waveform display:

- Drums (bold, centered)
- Bass (low, wide)
- Vocals (thin, responsive)
- Melody (soft curves)
- Harmonies (layered)
- FX (ambient wobble)

Each stem has its own color and motion profile.

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## 3. Section Visual Identities

Each section type has a distinct visual personality.

### 3.1 Intro - Cinematic & Filtered

- Desaturated palette
- Slow, drifting motion
- Soft blur on waveforms
- Text appears with film-grain fade

### 3.2 Hook - Bright, Rhythmic, Expansive

- High-contrast colors
- Tight, punchy waveform
- Glow around accent words
- Slight bounce on each beat

### 3.3 Verse - Gritty & Documentary

- Muted colors
- Minimal glow
- Slight camera-like jitter
- Waveforms feel raw and unprocessed

### 3.4 Bridge - Airy & Emotional

- Soft gradients
- Floating text spacing
- Waveforms stretch and breathe

### 3.5 Outro - Dissolving & Atmospheric

- Colors fade toward monochrome
- Text drifts upward
- Waveforms slowly flatten

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## 4. Typography System

Typography is a major storytelling tool.

### 4.1 Speaker-Based Styling

#### **Female:**

- Thin weight
- Cool tones
- Smooth transitions

#### **Male:**

- Heavier weight
- Warm tones
- Sharper transitions

#### **Sample:**

- Grainy texture overlay
- Slight warping

### 4.2 Word-Level Animation

#### **Accent words:**

- Cyan glow
- Scale up 1.1-1.2x
- Pulse on beat

#### **Non-accent words:**

- Fade in/out smoothly
- Subtle tracking changes

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## 5. Motion Language

All motion is tied to musical elements.

### 5.1 Beat-Driven Motion

- Waveform pulses on every beat
- Accent words pulse on strong beats
- Background lights oscillate with FX stem

### 5.2 Stem-Driven Motion

**Drums:** sharp vertical pulses

**Bass:** slow, heavy breathing motion

**Vocals:** smooth amplitude-based shimmer

**FX:** wobble, oscillation, atmospheric drift

### 5.3 Section Transitions

Transitions are cinematic:

- Crossfades
- Color shifts
- Typography morphs
- Waveform re-shapes

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## 6. Color System

Colors communicate emotion and section identity.

### 6.1 Section Colors

- **Intro:** dusty blue, charcoal
- **Hook:** neon cyan, deep violet
- **Verse:** muted gray, rust
- **Bridge:** soft lavender, pale gold
- **Outro:** fading teal, black

### 6.2 Speaker Colors

- **Female:** cool blues
- **Male:** warm ambers

- **Sample:** vintage sepia

## 6.3 Accent Colors

- Cyan glow for emphasis
  - White flash on beat drops
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## 7. UI States

### 7.1 Idle (Before Play)

- Waveforms dormant
- Text hidden
- Section label centered

### 7.2 Playing

- All reactive systems active
- Word highlighting
- Beat pulsing
- Section-aware visuals

### 7.3 Paused

- Waveforms freeze mid-motion
- Active word holds glow
- Background dims slightly

### 7.4 Scrubbing

- Waveforms preview position
  - Section label updates instantly
  - Text jumps to nearest line
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## 8. Interaction Model

The UI is mostly passive/observational, but supports:

- Play/Pause
- Scrubbing

- Section jumping (optional)
- Stem muting (optional)

All controls are minimal and unobtrusive.

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## 9. Summary

This UI is:

- Cinematic
- Music-reactive
- Section-aware
- Emotionally expressive
- Built around typography and waveform motion

It visually tells the story of **LOVE IN THE RUIN** through rhythm, color, and motion.

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